

Team Assignment 3 Question 1- Personas

Admissions Alchemists

Joseph Rissman, Yue Zhang, Nitin Krishna Bojji

Feb 12, 2025

1. Li Lei, age 24, is a Chinese graduate student completing his MS degree in Biomedical Science. Originally from China, he earned his bachelor's degree in Chemistry before pursuing his master's studies. Li is passionate about scientific research and is determined to pursue a PhD in the United States to further his academic career. Despite his strong research background, he struggles with academic writing in English and is unfamiliar with the specific expectations of U.S. graduate applications. Li hopes to craft compelling Statements of Purpose (SOPs) and Letters of Recommendation (LORs) that effectively showcase his research achievements and align with his PhD aspirations. He views GradAid as an essential tool to generate professional, grammatically accurate documents tailored to his needs while helping him refine his tone and clarity for a natural-sounding application.
2. Astha Jain, a 28-year-old from Jaipur, India, comes from a large family and was the first to attend college. She pursued her passion for medicine at Mahatma Gandhi University of Medical Sciences and Technology, earning a Bachelor of Medicine and Bachelor of Surgery (MBBS) degree with high marks. Although she initially aspired to become a surgeon, she faced challenges finding employment immediately after graduation. Relocating to New Delhi in search of opportunities, she worked as a server to support herself while continuing her job search. Eventually, she secured a position as a junior doctor at a family medicine practice, where she worked for two years until the practice closed due to financial difficulties. Following this setback, she accepted a nursing position at Jeewan Mala Hospital in New Delhi. This career detour, coupled with the demanding hours of her new role, has prompted her to re-evaluate her career path. She now plans to pursue a graduate degree in a growing and more lucrative field, such as computer science or finance. Having saved enough money to study in the United States, she hopes that a graduate degree from a top American university will open doors to high-paying jobs, enabling her to support her aging parents, whose ability to work is diminishing.

Unsure of which specific field to pursue, Astha is finding it difficult to identify suitable programs. Even when she finds a seemingly appropriate program, she struggles to articulate her diverse experiences in a compelling Statement of Purpose (SOP). While acknowledging that her career journey has been unconventional, she recognizes the valuable lessons and transferable skills she has acquired along the way. She believes that an educational consultant could be instrumental in navigating the application process by understanding her unique story, her personal journey, and her future ambitions.

3. Carlos Mendoza, age 26, is a software engineer from Mexico City with four years of experience in backend development. He earned his bachelor's degree in Computer Science from UNAM and has worked at a mid-sized tech company. Carlos has always been passionate about AI and machine learning and wants to pivot into research, but his current job focuses more on software development rather than deep AI work.

He plans to apply for an MS in Artificial Intelligence in the United States to gain the necessary academic background to transition into AI research roles. However, he is unfamiliar with the research-heavy SOPs required for graduate applications and has limited experience writing formal academic documents in English. He is also unsure how to best frame his work experience to demonstrate its relevance to AI research. He hopes GradAid will help him craft a strong SOP that highlights his technical background while showcasing his research potential in AI.